

Strixhaven Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

MTGNET

July 4, 2026

Dataset Snapshot

This run uses 132,902 unique deck builds and 582,914 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 7 learned archetypes. The best-performing large shells are Boros Spirit | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat, Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet, Izzet | Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and build-around incentives.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	27,411	127,004	57.20%	Pursue the Past, Wilt in the Heat, Rubble Rouser, Stone Docent, Spirit Mascot
Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	23,241	106,852	57.17%	Render Speechless, Melancholic Poet, Elite Interceptor, Imperious Inkmage, Cost of Brilliance
Izzet Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song	15,218	65,287	56.04%	Potioner's Trove, Snarl Song, Arcane Omens, Visionary's Dance, Archaic's Agony
Izzet Essence Scatter / Visionary's Dance	10,960	47,174	55.73%	Essence Scatter, Visionary's Dance, Run Behind, Quick Study, Vibrant Outburst
Simic Fractal Studious First-Year / Embrace the Paradox	23,796	100,253	53.87%	Studious First-Year, Embrace the Paradox, Pterafrectyl, Noxious Newt, Fractal Mascot
Golgari Pest Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	19,353	82,682	53.86%	Grapple with Death, Bogwater Lumaret, Send in the Pest, Mindful Biomancer, Pest Mascot

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Izzet Elementals Elemental Mascot / Stadium Tidalimage	12,923	53,662	51.60%	Elemental Mascot, Stadium Tidalimage, Spectacular Skywhale, Deluge Virtuoso, Landscape Painter

2 What Defines the Best Shells

Boros Spirit | Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat

This cluster contains 27,411 decks across 127,004 games and posts a baseline win rate of 57.20%. Its defining cards are **Pursue the Past**, **Wilt in the Heat**, **Rubble Rouser**, **Stone Docent**, **Spirit Mascot**, **Ascendant Dustspeaker**.

The strongest positive links in the shell are **Primary Research + Spirit Mascot**. The build-around detector flags **Spirit Mascot**, **Primary Research** as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Orzhov | Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet

This cluster contains 23,241 decks across 106,852 games and posts a baseline win rate of 57.17%. Its defining cards are **Render Speechless**, **Melancholic Poet**, **Elite Interceptor**, **Imperious Inkimage**, **Cost of Brilliance**, **Inkling Mascot**.

The strongest positive links in the shell are **Killian's Confidence + Melancholic Poet**. The build-around detector flags **Killian's Confidence**, **Melancholic Poet** as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Izzet | Potioneer's Trove / Snarl Song

This cluster contains 15,218 decks across 65,287 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.04%. Its defining cards are **Potioneer's Trove**, **Snarl Song**, **Arcane Omens**, **Visionary's Dance**, **Archaic's Agony**, **Sundering Archaic**.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Izzet | Essence Scatter / Visionary's Dance

This cluster contains 10,960 decks across 47,174 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.73%. Its defining cards are **Essence Scatter**, **Visionary's Dance**, **Run Behind**, **Quick Study**, **Vibrant Outburst**, **Sanar**, **Unfinished Genius**.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

3 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Card	Best cluster	Standalone lift	Drawn-game WR	Games
Together as One	Izzet Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song	16.06 pp	72.10%	4218
Emeritus of Ideation	Simic Fractal Studios First-Year / Embrace the Paradox	15.54 pp	69.41%	1484
Practiced Offense	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	12.30 pp	69.47%	3498
Stargaze	Izzet Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song	10.63 pp	66.67%	138
Exhibition Tidecaller	Izzet Essence Scatter / Visionary's Dance	10.19 pp	65.93%	2923
Snarl Song	Izzet Potioner's Trove / Snarl Song	10.14 pp	66.18%	10715
Colorstorm Stallion	Izzet Elementals Elemental Mascot / Stadium Tidalimage	10.03 pp	61.63%	3242
Traumatic Critique	Izzet Essence Scatter / Visionary's Dance	9.66 pp	65.39%	2641
Splatter Technique	Izzet Essence Scatter / Visionary's Dance	9.60 pp	65.33%	3072
Ark of Hunger	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	9.56 pp	66.76%	6736
Moment of Reckoning	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	9.36 pp	66.53%	5336
Professor Dellian Fel	Golgari Pest Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	9.31 pp	63.16%	1675

4 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Spirit Mascot	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	10.0 / 10	6.01 pp	28471

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Primary Research	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	10.0 / 10	11.36 pp	9473
Killian's Confidence	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	10.0 / 10	10.95 pp	9820
Melancholic Poet	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	8.5 / 10	3.48 pp	16409

5 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Melancholic Poet	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	0.164	0.39 pp	17536
Killian's Confidence	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	0.164	0.57 pp	10323
Spirit Mascot	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.134	-1.36 pp	30707
Primary Research	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.134	-0.36 pp	9966
Wilt in the Heat	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.000	1.51 pp	28655
Rubble Rouser	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.000	1.57 pp	27869
Pursue the Past	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.000	2.18 pp	27383
Stone Docent	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.000	-0.36 pp	23294
Elite Interceptor	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.000	1.16 pp	22494
Tome Blast	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.000	1.96 pp	19865
Owlin Historian	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.000	-0.76 pp	17731
Ascendant Dustspeaker	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.000	0.54 pp	17348

6 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Together as One	Izzet Potioneer's Trove / Snarl Song	10.0 / 10	5.21 pp	rare
Ark of Hunger	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	10.0 / 10	4.46 pp	rare
Snarl Song	Izzet Potioneer's Trove / Snarl Song	10.0 / 10	2.37 pp	uncommon
Practiced Offense	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	10.0 / 10	4.43 pp	rare
Environmental Scientist	Simic Fractal Studious First-Year / Embrace the Paradox	9.7 / 10	2.33 pp	uncommon
Moment of Reckoning	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	10.0 / 10	2.73 pp	rare
Antiquities on the Loose	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	10.0 / 10	3.96 pp	rare
Paradox Surveyor	Simic Fractal Studious First-Year / Embrace the Paradox	9.5 / 10	1.47 pp	uncommon
Colorstorm Stallion	Izzet Elementals Elemental Mascot / Stadium Tidalmage	10.0 / 10	3.38 pp	rare
Stress Dream	Izzet Elementals Elemental Mascot / Stadium Tidalmage	10.0 / 10	2.26 pp	uncommon
Sundering Archaic	Simic Fractal Studious First-Year / Embrace the Paradox	8.9 / 10	1.49 pp	uncommon
Essenceknit Scholar	Golgari Pest Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	10.0 / 10	1.91 pp	uncommon

7 Most Striking Positive Pairs

Pair	Cluster	Quality	Pair WR	Games
Killian's Confidence, Melancholic Poet	Orzhov Render Speechless / Melancholic Poet	0.72	62.05%	2029
Primary Research, Spirit Mascot	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.36	58.75%	2919

8 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pair	Cluster	Anti-score	Pair WR	Games
Moseo, Vein's New Dean, Tenured Concocter	Golgari Pest Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	0.31	50.94%	267
Goblin Glasswright, Hydro-Channeler	Izzet Elementals Ele- mental Mascot / Stadium Tidalmage	0.29	48.14%	1180
Living History, Spirit Mascot	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.26	53.85%	3363
Elite Interceptor, Stone Docent	Boros Spirit Pursue the Past / Wilt in the Heat	0.21	55.80%	4909
Imperious Inkmage, Rehearsed Debater	Orzhov Render Speech- less / Melancholic Poet	0.20	53.79%	1874
Burrog Banemaker, Pest Mascot	Golgari Pest Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	0.20	51.13%	1510
Inkling Mascot, Scolding Administrator	Orzhov Render Speech- less / Melancholic Poet	0.20	55.70%	2912
Last Gasp, Witherbloom Charm	Golgari Pest Grapple with Death / Bogwater Lumaret	0.17	52.36%	911
Melancholic Poet, Shattered Acolyte	Orzhov Render Speech- less / Melancholic Poet	0.16	54.82%	2023
Scolding Administrator, Shattered Acolyte	Orzhov Render Speech- less / Melancholic Poet	0.16	55.67%	1489

9 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. The strongest cards show up in the bomb table because they win on their own. The cards that pull a cluster together show up in the build-around and dependency tables because they need a shell. The pair and anti-synergy sections then explain which combinations reinforce a winning plan and which combinations look attractive in draft but underperform together.